

heritage festival Living the Legacy

JODHPUR Great ambience and superlative performances by musicians, dancers and folk artistes have always spelt magic at heritage festivals. So if you want to experience that heady feeling, go to Jodhpur for the Rajasthan International Folk Festival (RIFF) at Mehrangarh Fort from October 25-29. Built on a hillock, the spectacular fort overlooks the city of Jodhpur—famous for its blue buildings and lac bangles and textiles.

Mehrangarh Fort was more recently in the news as the venue for Liz Hurley and Arun Nayar's wedding. Normally, the fort is closed to visitors after nightfall but it will remain open during the festival.

The festival, which has been timed to coincide with Sharad Poornima will see performances by at least 250 singers, dancers, instrumentalists, storytellers and artisans from across the world. "Rajasthan is rich in folk tradition. So the local

artistes have been given an opportunity to showcase the vibrancy, colour and energy of their work. This time they will perform with international artistes on the same stage," says Faith Singh, the founder of the Jaipur Virasat Foundation.

The erstwhile maharaja of Jodhpur, Gaj Singh will inaugurate the festival with a ceremonial procession. Fifteen Rajasthani folk communities will take part in the musical gala.

Some of the artistes who are going to perform include flute maestro Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia, sitar maestro Pandit Krishna Mohan Bhatt and Indian Ocean, a rock-fusion band that combines electrifying rhythm with shlokas, sufiana qalam and folk.

This year's attraction, however, will be the international band Tarhana, which is synonymous with folk traditions from Eastern Europe and Central Asia and will perform to gypsy melodies and North African rhythms. A festival not to be missed.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

SOULFUL SYMPHONY: Chaurasia (left); Members of the rock band Indian Ocean get ready for the magic



YASBANT NEGI



MANPREET ROMANA

art A New Canvas

MUMBAI The painter's angst is reflected in her works. And her canvas turns into a cathartic medium that she expresses herself on. Spanish by origin, Gayatri Gamuz, 41, presents *In a Land without Trees*, her first solo show, at Hacienda Gallery in Mumbai. Gamuz paints a symbolically devastated garden and living in this 'land without trees' is a daily challenge. "The modern world imposes on the individual, the wonderful, as well as the attractive," explains Gamuz. In her paintings, she plays with the symbolism of toys and plastic elements as metaphors of the capitalistic culture which separates man from the natural world. "The plastic elements are a sarcastic portrait of the unconscious human presence in the natural world," she adds. "Gayatri's paintings have a sense of innocence, purity and tranquility," says curator Jasmine Shah Varma. On till October 25.

by Swati Mathur

DEVASTATED GARDEN: Provisional Trees by Gamuz



theatre Play Right

BANGALORE Theatre Science from the UK heads towards the next phase of its outreach programme with Imaging the Future-India. Plymouth Theatres in association with Jagriti Theatre, Bangalore, will see two new performances especially created for the occasion, a series of workshops and seminars involving both artistes and scientists, and the reading of two new



Actors of *The Invisible River* Indian works and one by a British playwright. There will be performances of new plays—*Crab Soup* by Arthur Cardozo and *The Invisible River* by Gautam Raja. October 22-27 at Alliance Francaise de Bangalore.

by Nirmala Ravindran